

2026 NFL Coaching Changes & Playcaller Guide

Built for fantasy / Best-Ball prep — who actually calls the plays, their scheme, and what it moves.

Coordinator list CBS-sourced & web-verified (June 2026); BAL DC confirmed (Minter). Not re-verified live this session.

The one thing that matters: who calls the plays

A new offensive coordinator only changes the offense if he actually calls the plays. League-wide, **18 of 32 head coaches call their own offense**; only 8 teams are “HC-as-CEO” where a coordinator runs it. So of the 21 OC-title changes in 2026, only ~14 actually move the offense — 4 of those are really head-coach hires, and ~6 are noise (continuity). Attribute the offense to the play-caller, not the title.

The dominant pattern: most of the real new offenses are **Shanahan / McVay tree** (LAC, MIA, ATL, ARI, LV, TB, SEA). Their shared signature — quick game + heavy play-action, pre-snap motion, under-center, zone run, RBs in the pass game — raises efficiency and pass-catching-back value, **spreads target distribution** (tempers WR1 target concentration), and compresses raw pass rate. Clay’s pass% prices volume, not these distribution effects.

Who calls the plays — at a glance

Bucket	Teams
New HC runs offense	ARI (LaFleur), CLE (Monken), LV (Kubiak), PIT (McCarthy)
New OC genuinely calls it	ATL (Rees/Stefanski), CAR (Idzik), DEN (Webb), DET (Petzing), LAC (McDaniel), MIA (Slowik), NYG (Nagy), NYJ (Reich), TB (Z. Robinson), TEN (Daboll)
First-time callers — widen error bars	BAL (Doyle), PHI (Mannion), SEA (Fleury), WAS (Blough)
Continuity — ignore the OC headline	BUF (Brady), KC (Reid), LAR (McVay), CHI (Ben Johnson), DAL (Schottenheimer), GB (M. LaFleur)

Offensive playcaller profiles

New head coach calls the offense

ARI — Mike LaFleur (HC, new; Gannon fired) — OC Hackett does NOT call plays

- **Tree:** Shanahan/Kyle (ex-SF/NYJ OC)
- **Scheme:** wide-zone + heavy play-action, pre-snap motion, under-center looks
- **Fantasy:** Murray gone → pocket-QB fit; efficiency should rise but target distribution spreads — temper any Cardinal WR1’s target concentration. Do not model as “Hackett’s offense.”

CLE — Todd Monken (HC, new)

- **Tree:** Air Coryell (vertical)
- **Scheme:** vertical play-action, ~68% motion (high), RBs featured — the one genuinely vertical new offense here
- **Fantasy:** downfield + motion = WR aDOT/ceiling friendly; RBs stay involved. Was elite for Lamar in BAL — which is why BAL replacing him is a downgrade (below).

LV — Klint Kubiak (HC, new; Janocko is titular OC)

- **Tree:** Shanahan/Kubiak

- **Scheme:** wide-zone, heavy motion + 12-personnel, deep PA bootlegs, ~27.9% play-action, RBs as receivers (made rookie Kamara elite)
- **Fantasy:** Ashton Jeanty is the clean winner. Brock Bowers gets a PA/TE bump but soften it — rookie QB likely means a conservative “tight-to-the-vest” Year 1.

PIT — Mike McCarthy (HC, new)

- **Tree:** West Coast
- **Scheme:** timing West Coast, Rodgers quick game + checkdowns, suppresses scramble
- **Fantasy:** short-area/possession passing; lifts pass-catching backs & underneath WR/TE over vertical X receivers

New OC who genuinely calls the plays

LAC — Mike McDaniel (OC, new)

- **Tree:** Shanahan
- **Scheme:** Miami-style ~70% motion, PA + screens, zone run, downfield off PA; Herbert ~2.4s release
- **Fantasy:** Omarion Hampton up (zone run + RB pass game), Herbert efficiency up. Risk: timing offense needs a clean pocket — OL/sacks would undercut it. Targets spread.

MIA — Bobby Slowik (OC, new)

- **Tree:** Shanahan (ex-HOU OC)
- **Scheme:** motion/PA/screens, horizontal spacing — not a vertical bomber
- **Fantasy:** scheme is friendly but the WR room was gutted — the open question is De’Von Achane’s role/ceiling, not a clean WR boost

TEN — Brian Daboll (OC, new)

- **Tree:** Erhardt-Perkins (Josh Allen’s developer)
- **Scheme:** motion + condensed splits + deep PA, WR/RB featured
- **Fantasy:** with rookie Cam Ward, pass volume should climb as he develops — buy the trajectory

ATL — Tommy Rees (OC) under HC Kevin Stefanski’s system

- **Tree:** Stefanski/Shanahan wide-zone
- **Scheme:** under-center #1 (2024), wide-zone + heavy PA, possession passing, strict pocket
- **Fantasy:** TE-friendly (12-personnel) → Kyle Pitts upside is the headline

DET — Drew Petzing (OC, new)

- **Tree:** under-center / play-action family
- **Scheme:** heavy under-center + play-action (charts strongly), motion + RPO; his Arizona scheme skewed run-heavy/short, Goff is a pocket QB
- **Fantasy:** under-center PA boosts Goff + PA receivers; watch whether Ben-Johnson-era juice carries or regresses toward Petzing’s conservative AZ baseline

TB — Zac Robinson (OC, new)

- **Tree:** McVay
- **Scheme:** motion/PA/wide-zone for Mayfield; Bowles DC unchanged
- **Fantasy:** Bucky Irving more receptions, Mayfield bounce-back — but target distribution gets watered down, so temper a WR1’s concentration

NYG — Matt Nagy (OC, calls plays)

- **Tree:** Reid / West Coast
- **Scheme:** West Coast/spread, misdirection, RPO, motion for Dart
- **Fantasy:** motion + pass-catching-friendly; Reid-tree QB development angle

NYJ — Frank Reich (OC, new)

- **Tree:** veteran (Frazier/Coryell lineage)
- **Scheme:** RB/TE motion to ID coverage, quick game for Geno, strict pocket
- **Fantasy:** quick-game/possession-leaning; underneath targets + RB receiving over deep shots

DEN — Davis Webb (OC, new caller; Payton handed it off)

- **Tree:** Payton / spread-Air-Raid roots
- **Scheme:** spread + vertical (Waddle field-stretcher), deep RB room
- **Fantasy:** vertical tilt; note this flipped from continuity — Payton delegating makes it a real (if Payton-influenced) change

CAR — Brad Idzik (OC, new caller)

- **Tree:** Canales / Shanahan-ish
- **Scheme:** wide-zone committing to more motion, short aDOT, RB screens
- **Fantasy:** short-area, RB-screen friendly; lower-aDOT WR usage

First-time play-callers — real change, widen the error bars

BAL — Declan Doyle (OC, first-time)

- **Scheme:** Payton/Johnson-tree motion + explosive PA + Lamar bootlegs
- **Caution:** DOWNGRADE RISK — replaces Todd Monken, who was elite for Lamar. Not the reflexive “new OC = improvement.”

SEA — Brian Fleury (OC, first-time; Kubiak left for the LV HC job)

- **Scheme:** ~80% the same wide-zone/under-center/PA family + more motion/tempo (Fleury from SF); Darnold a pocket QB
- **Caution:** DOWNGRADE FLAG — Kubiak was Seattle's 2025 caller and the reason JSN broke out. Handing it to unproven Fleury makes the SEA pass game / JSN a downgrade risk, not neutral.

PHI — Sean Mannion (OC, first-time)

- **Tree:** McVay/LaFleur (motion wide-zone, not run-heavy quick game); HC Sirianni is CEO, Hurts has designed runs
- **Fantasy:** scheme historically targets RBs → Saquon's receiving role could expand, DeVonta Smith a larger uncontested share. But modeled pass attempts are down post-A.J. Brown — neutral-to-cautious.

WAS — David Blough (OC, first-time)

- **Scheme:** more under-center/balanced, less shotgun for Jayden Daniels
- **Fantasy:** the dials suggest a more grounded, less-scramble Daniels — a meaningful style change for a QB whose 2025 value leaned on mobility. Widest error bars of the group.

Continuity — OC title churned, 2025 play-caller stayed (no scheme change)

- **BUF — Joe Brady** (now HC, still calls). Evolving toward more PA + motion than assumed — not pure “nothing changed.”
- **KC — Andy Reid** calls it; Bieniemy is a support/reunion hire.
- **LAR — Sean McVay** calls it (#1 in play-action league-wide); Scheelhaase internal promo.
- **CHI — Ben Johnson** (hired 2025, not new): most explosive offense in the NFL, #2 motion two years running, #2 PA, 13-personnel multi-TE (Loveland + Kmet) → Caleb Williams leap + a live TE room. Press Taylor is support.
- **DAL — Brian Schottenheimer** (year 2); GB — Matt LaFleur calls it.

Don't move players on these OC headlines — Clay already models them as no-change.

Defensive coordinator changes & scheme

14 teams hired a new DC. Six have a quantified scheme tendency that shifts the matchup read; the rest are regressed toward mean (low confidence) until confirmed. A new DC changes a team's man/zone + blitz identity — so the personnel-based funnel is least reliable for these teams.

BAL — Jesse Minter (DC, confirmed)

- **Scheme:** ~81% zone, two-high split-field, low man, low blitz, front-four pressure (ex-LAC DC)
- **Read:** BAL becomes zone-heavy / two-high → suppresses deep shots; target underneath, slot, TE, YAC and pass-catching RBs over vertical man-beaters

TEN — Gus Bradley

- **Scheme:** heavy Cover-3 ZONE (~55% Cover-3, led NFL 2023), low man
- **Read:** makes TEN a ZONE pass-funnel → target zone-beaters: slot, TE, YAC WRs, pass-catching RBs; fade pure man-beating vertical X receivers

SF — Raheem Morris

- **Scheme:** MORE man + aggressive (5+ rushers ~ $\frac{1}{3}$), multiple change-ups vs Saleh's zone
- **Read:** SF stays near-fortress but shifts man-heavy → the way in is man-beating separators, not zone-settlers

PIT — Patrick Graham

- **Scheme:** two-high, split-field, press corners, low blitz (~25th)
- **Read:** two-high suppresses deep shots → PIT's soft 2025 coverage likely firms vs explosives; production tilts underneath/RB, not deep WR booms

NYG — Dennard Wilson

- **Scheme:** attacking, smart-blitz, DB-coach pass-defense emphasis
- **Read:** NYG's extreme pass-funnel should firm — coverage is his specialty. Downgrade the "torch the Giants secondary" assumption.

GB — Jonathan Gannon

- **Scheme:** LOW blitz (~17–18%), front-four pressure, 3-safety looks
- **Read:** run-funnel intact but cleaner QB pockets (fewer free rushers) → steadier opposing-QB matchup; opposing RB/underneath still the exploit

Low-confidence new DCs (regressed to mean until confirmed): BUF Leonhard, CLE Rutenberg, DAL Parker, LAC O'Leary, LV Leonard, MIA Duggan, NYJ Duker, WAS D. Jones.

Charted tendency leaderboards (the scheme tags Clay's pass% misses)

- **Motion at snap:** Ben Johnson (#2, 2 yrs), M. LaFleur, Coen, O'Connell, Joe Brady; Kubiak mid-pack.
- **Play-action:** McVay #1, Ben Johnson #2, Joe Brady #3 (up from 25th), Kubiak, O'Connell, M. LaFleur, Petzing.
- **Under-center dropbacks:** Stefanski #1 (2024); Ben Johnson, O'Connell, McVay, Kubiak, Petzing, McDaniel, LaFleur all heavy. Under-center PA boosts QB efficiency + play-action WRs.

Verify before you cite

- **NE — Josh McDaniels with Drake Maye:** charted analysts repeatedly praised this as a top play-caller / elite-fantasy-QB setup, but the sourced registry didn't capture NE's 2026 caller. Verify NE's OC/play-caller before acting on a Maye bump.

- **Provenance:** the offensive play-caller list was web-verified June 2026 but not re-checked this session; BAL's DC is confirmed as Jesse Minter. Live-verify any specific team on request.